

Complaints and Vulnerable Members Policy

Organisation	North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU)
Version	1.8
Status	CURRENT
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Policy owner	Member Experience Manager
Classification	Synthetic training material

Document control note: users must confirm status and effective date before relying on a rule. Superseded documents are retained in this synthetic corpus deliberately so that retrieval pipelines can be tested for version awareness.

1. Complaint Recognition

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies complaint recognition in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
1.1	A complaint is any expression of dissatisfaction where a response or resolution is expected, regardless of the channel used.
1.2	Colleagues must not require the member to use specific words or a formal form before recognising a complaint.
1.3	Complaints arising during arrears conversations must be recorded while appropriate account management continues.

Control 1. A complaint is any expression of dissatisfaction where a response or resolution is expected, regardless of the channel used. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. Colleagues must not require the member to use specific words or a formal form before recognising a complaint. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

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Control 3. Complaints arising during arrears conversations must be recorded while appropriate account management continues. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

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Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

2. Investigation and Root Cause

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies investigation and root cause in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

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Ref	Key requirement
2.1	Investigations must consider what happened, why it happened, member impact, remediation and whether other members may be affected.
2.2	Repeated complaints with a common root cause must be aggregated for management review.
2.3	Operational incidents and complaints should be linked where one event affects multiple members.

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Control 2. Repeated complaints with a common root cause must be aggregated for management review. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

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Control 3. Operational incidents and complaints should be linked where one event affects multiple members. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

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3. Vulnerable Members

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies vulnerable members in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

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Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

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3.1	Vulnerability may arise from health, life events, resilience or capability and can be temporary, permanent or fluctuating.
3.2	Reasonable adjustments should be recorded in practical terms and reviewed where circumstances change.
3.3	A vulnerability flag must not be interpreted as a negative credit score.

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Control 3. A vulnerability flag must not be interpreted as a negative credit score. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

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4. Communication and Redress

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies communication and redress in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

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4.1	Responses should be clear, proportionate and explain any correction or redress.
4.2	Where a payroll or system failure caused incorrect arrears treatment, the member record and any associated charges must be corrected.
4.3	Compensation should be considered consistently using approved authority.

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Control 3. Compensation should be considered consistently using approved authority. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

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5. Management Information

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies management information in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

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5.1	Monthly complaints MI must include volume, upheld rate, ageing, root cause, product, channel, vulnerability indicators and repeat complaints.
5.2	A sudden increase in complaints linked to one operational process should trigger incident review.
5.3	Root-cause reporting must distinguish member misunderstanding from process, system, supplier or training failures.

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Control 3. Root-cause reporting must distinguish member misunderstanding from process, system, supplier or training failures. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

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